



PROGRESS REPORT

Public debate and participation in policymaking: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-4 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

53 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

NON-GOVERNMENTAL CONTRIBUTION TO NATIONAL POLICY · OPEN DISCUSSION OF GOVERNMENT POLICY

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Non-governmental contribution to national policy

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The artificial intelligence bill's consultation portal recorded 18 contributions from companies, 18 from specialists and 5 from the public by August 2026. There is a general duty and, for the first time on this base, a count against it. The administrative procedure code of 2022 requires administrative bodies to enable participation by individuals and associations in forming decisions, with hearing of interested parties and public consultation on draft regulations. The artificial intelligence bill is where that was exercised and measured. The ministry's consultation portal recorded 18 contributions from companies, 18 from specialists and 5 from the general public as at 27 August 2026, against a 20-page bill dated September 2025. The digital government bill went out to consultation in May 2026 without a comparable count published.	MOVEMENT
Benin	Open government co-creation opened in July 2026 with commune-level consultation, eighteen months after the country joined the partnership. A school on internet governance was held in Ouidah with human rights at the centre of its programme (report). 2026-07-29 — co-creation of the first open government national action plan opened at a Cotonou workshop with commune-level consultation, eighteen months after accession. Nothing existed before it. The eighteen-month gap is the finding: joining was the act, and the plan that gives it content is only now being written. No commitments, no timetable and no civil-society membership of the process is published. The other non-governmental contribution on this ledger is not consultative at all — a non-governmental organisation issuing identity cards, reported under registration of the population, which uncovered failures in the state's own enrolment data by doing the state's work.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Botswana	The National Planning Act provides the formal channel, while civil society rejected the constitution amendment process outright. 2024-01-30 — the Act establishes the National Planning Commission, a duty to liaise with civil society and a power to form thematic working groups. 2025-08-20 — the civil-society umbrella body mobilised against and formally rejected the Constitution (Amendment) Bill No. 14 of 2025, demanding a people-driven Constitutional Review Act. 2026-02-10 — the same body pressed government directly for structured and inclusive participation on the proposed Constitutional Court, six months after the rejection. The base holds no record of a thematic working group being convened under the Act.	MIXED a statutory channel alongside a contested one
Burkina Faso	Two documented instances, both in the state's own record: parliamentary hearings with the internet society chapter and the digital-sector federation in June 2024, and an artificial-intelligence roadmap validated with non-state actors in June 2026. 2024-06-11 - the legislature's sustainable development commission held formal hearings over two days with the internet society chapter, the federation of digital-sector associations and independent specialists, alongside government bodies, during drafting of the information-systems security law. It is the base's clearest evidence of non-state input into a bill. 2025-08-27 - the artificial-intelligence roadmap opened with a workshop convening public institutions, the private sector, universities, research centres, civil society and technical and financial partners into thematic sub-groups, and was validated on 17 June 2026 having mobilised the same constituencies plus the diaspora. Both are consultations the state convened. No standing mechanism, register of submissions or published response document is held, and the regulator of public communication is being folded into a merged authority whose consultation duties are not stated.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	A consumer association called for a national convention on communications after denouncing service degradation, with no response from government or operators on file. 2026-07-31 — the consumer association denounced degradation of telecommunications service and proposed a national convention on communications. No convening date, government response or operator response is on file. It is the only non-governmental intervention in digital policy this ledger records. The same association is behind the tariff account reported under affordability, and the regulator's injunctions on value-added services followed its complaints — so the one civil-society actor visible in the record is a consumer body acting on billing rather than a research or advocacy sector engaging with strategy.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	The 2026 internet governance forum convened at Yaounde, and the finance ministry began civil-society budget sensitisation. 2026-08-18 to 20 - the national internet governance forum was held at Yaounde, the first edition the base records; no prior edition, participant list or outcome text is held, so what non-governmental participants contributed is unrecorded. 2026-04 - the finance ministry was running first-contact sensitisation with civil society on budget oversight, eight years after the transparency code that requires civil-society involvement was promulgated. The pattern in both is a channel opening without an output: a forum with no resolutions on file and a consultation obligation reaching first contact after eight years.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	A digital week was instituted as an annual national platform by resolution, and the advisory council met in November 2025. 2026-02 - the digital week was instituted by resolution as an annual national platform with five stated objectives covering digital literacy, public-sector modernisation, digitalisation of the economy, startup support and monitoring of the digital strategy, having been held as an event with no standing instrument before; the 2026 edition ran 9 to 15 March in hybrid format, opening on Brava. It is financed from the state budget and partnerships, and no budget line for it is identified in any budget document held. 2025-11-25 - the digital economy advisory council, chaired by the responsible minister, held its third ordinary meeting, at which the state set its programme on three pillars - digital public services, e-commerce and digital payments - supported by four declared work areas; no meeting after that date is recorded.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Central African Republic	Non-state bodies supply what the state does not: a fact-check on payment fraud and a national AI grouping. What the base holds under this heading is a pattern rather than a policy contribution. A community fact-checking network debunked a mobile-money phishing scam where no regulator statement exists. A national representative introduced an artificial-intelligence pioneers grouping at the continent's main machine-learning gathering where no national strategy has appeared. And an incubator describes itself as the country's first. None is recorded as consulted on, cited in or responded to by any government instrument.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Chad	A citizens' organisation petitioned the regulator over network quality in August 2026, citing 500 signatures and 70 testimonies. The one standing multi-stakeholder mechanism is the national internet governance forum, self-described as created in 2014 to debate public internet policy between government, regulator, civil society and private sector, and carrying no binding consultation mandate (forum). Two dated instances of input fall in the window. A three-day workshop opened on 18 May 2026 drafting the first national data governance strategy included technology incubators and information-security specialists among its participants (workshop). And a citizens' organisation formally petitioned the regulator on 28 August 2026 over network coverage and quality, after a thirty-day deadline to the operator expired unanswered, citing over 500 signatures and more than 70 documented testimonies (petition).	MOVEMENT
Comoros	A first national artificial-intelligence forum was held at Moroni in April 2026 under ministry patronage. 2026-04 - the first edition was held on the theme of digital inclusion under ministry patronage, with the digital agency, the regulator, the technology association and the university taking part. No second edition, communique or follow-up instrument is held. The minister called it a starting point, and nothing on file says it produced anything. It is the only convening on digital policy the base records for this country in the window, and the non-state participants are a professional association and a university rather than civil society.	MOVEMENT
Congo	A national consultation issued inclusive recommendations in February 2026. 2026-02-20 — the national consultation at Djambala issued recommendations described as inclusive. The ledger's other entries on this subject are a citizen election-monitoring report and a published assessment of internet development, both non-governmental. What is absent is any record of such contributions being taken up in a policy instrument.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	Consumer associations, operators and industry bodies validated a complaints procedure now before the regulator's council for adoption. 2026-08-13 to 14 - a procedure for handling consumer complaints on electronic communications was validated at a two-day Assinie workshop with operators, internet service providers and consumer associations, and goes to the regulator's regulatory council for adoption, implementing the 2024 electronic communications law. No draft text, adoption date or redress standard is published. 2025-07-31 - the IPv6 migration strategy and action plan were validated with about twenty public and private bodies, and have not been adopted or published since. The pattern is consultation at validation stage on instruments that then stop being reported.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	Four dated consultations in the period took non-government participants into policy formation, from the development plan to the AI strategy. 2025-08-06 - a regional consultation at Dikhil for the third national development plan brought elected officials, local authorities, civil society and experts into the plan's formulation, each region required to produce a validated contribution report. 2025-10-06 - co-design workshops with producers, extension agents, community radios, associations and private-sector actors produced an editorial and data-governance framework for digital agricultural advisory services. 2025-12-06 - a validation workshop at Tadjourah reviewed the draft national land policy with ministries, regional authorities and national institutions. 2026-01-22 - a national AI-strategy workshop of about eighty participants included academia alongside government, the United Nations, the private sector and civil society.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
DR Congo	A standing state-industry consultation mechanism was agreed on 6 August 2026 after the dispute over the digital-sector tariff. 2026-08-06 - a working session between the digital economy minister and the sector network agreed a permanent consultation framework after the dispute over the digital-sector tariff, and announced a strategic barometer to give government figures on firms' scope of activity, turnover, growth and job creation. No constituting text, membership or meeting schedule is stated for the framework, and no operator, methodology or first-issue date for the barometer. Both were proposed by the industry body rather than instituted by the state, and both follow a tariff dispute in which an order took effect, was said to be suspended, and was then said not to be.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	A syndicate-backed freedom of information bill secured 60 signatures; the regulator has a consultation framework. 2026-08-10 - a syndicate-backed freedom of information bill was submitted after securing 60 lawmakers' signatures, proposing an authority for the protection of freedom of information - the clearest instance on this ledger of a non-governmental body carrying a legislative proposal into parliament. The formal channel exists on paper: the telecom regulator's bilingual framework for public consultations. No consultation held under it, and no response document, is recorded. An independent analysis of 28,311 job postings is research rather than policy input, and nothing records it being taken up.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	The consultation body created by decree in 2021 had its composition deferred and nothing records it meeting. The decree adopting the national sustainable development strategy creates an observatory as the consultation channel and defers its composition. Five years on, nothing in the base records it constituted or meeting. Where non-state voices do reach policy it is through single events: a second national artificial intelligence forum in May 2026 brought ministry, university and international researchers together on artificial intelligence policy.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	Technical workshops in Asmara brought government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants into planning for the first time on the base (workshops). A water project held two rounds of geodesign workshops in Asmara in July 2026 with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants, using a geodesign platform with high-resolution hydrological modelling for two catchments, alongside a modelling training session for Eritrean technical experts (workshops). Eritrea completed its first national development plan, described as drafted through participatory, gender-responsive and results-based methods with cross-ministerial and stakeholder consultation (annual report). Both accounts are the conveners' own descriptions of process, not independent evidence of influence, and they sit against a state that systematically silences criticism (findings).	MOVEMENT
Eswatini	The national data policy was drafted and validated through workshops taking in the private sector, civil society and academia. A two-day stakeholders' workshop opened on 29 April 2026 with European Union, member state and GIZ support to begin drafting the national data policy (workshop), and a validation workshop in July put the draft to government ministries, regulators, the private sector, civil society, academia and development partners (validation). The standing structure for it is provided rather than operating: the Computer Crime and Cybercrime Act establishes a National Cybersecurity Advisory Council, and no appointment, membership or meeting record is held (Act). Where non-government scrutiny has bitten it was after the fact, in the public account demanded of a cloud memorandum after a contradiction between ministry and company. Participation on this base is by invitation to a workshop, not by a standing right to be consulted.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	A civil-society project on climate disinformation launched in August 2026 will track government communications ahead of the November climate conference. The project covers Uganda and Ethiopia under a wider international initiative, and combines research mapping how climate disinformation spreads and who drives it with a fact-checking masterclass at the 2026 internet-freedom forum and online training for journalists and civil society (project launch). No budget or duration is stated, and the base holds no other instance of non-governmental input to national digital policy: no consultation record, no submission and no published response to one.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	The draft national development plan for 2026-2030 was opened to public contribution on 13 January 2026. The planning ministry published the provisional Plan national de croissance et de développement 2026-2030 online and invited citizens, civil society organisations, the private sector, young people, women and the diaspora to submit observations, proposals and suggestions before it is finalised. No count of contributions received, and no account of which were taken up, is held.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The regulator opened eight draft instruments to public comment in April 2026 under published consultation guidelines. The consultation notice and guidelines of 2 April 2026 put eight draft regulatory instruments out for comment at once, among them enforcement regulations and a unified fee code covering every regulated sector. The practice predates the guidelines. Stakeholders validated ex-ante wholesale and retail telecom pricing tools in November 2025, a draft e-commerce policy was validated with private-sector participants in September 2025, and the national policy handbook mandates participatory, evidence-based policymaking.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	A fifth open-government action plan for 2024-2028 was co-created from March 2023, and a community media cyber project is training about 60 media houses. The standing channel is the open government partnership, joined in 2011. The fifth national action plan, published in December 2023 for 2024 to 2028, was co-created from March 2023 through consultative meetings with a multi-stakeholder forum and civil-society organisations working in fisheries, health and power, and a review of the fourth plan, which ended in June 2023. It is organised on accountability, transparency, participation and technology, and carries commitments on asset declaration, beneficial ownership, right to information and the open data initiative. Its own diagnosis of what went wrong before is the useful part: misalignment between workplans, budgets and commitments, implementing agencies unaware of what they had agreed, and broad unrealistic commitments. The capture holds front matter and introduction only, so no commitment text, milestone or lead agency is on file. A Czech-funded community media cyber project runs with the cyber security authority and a digital-transformation centre, in Accra through August 2026 and Kumasi in September, certifying those who complete every session (project). A session on 19 August put newsroom devices to journalists as deliberate targets (training). The press corps is proposed rather than constituted, with no budget published (press corps).	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	Platform blocking followed the November 2025 takeover; a law against false online information followed in May. The channel non-state actors had been using is documented: a preprint maps online networks of around 445,000 followers driving political mobilisation since 2013. It narrowed sharply. Coup leaders ordered radio shutdowns and blocked four major platforms nationwide in November 2025, and the transitional council passed a law against false online information in May 2026. Structured participation continues in donor programmes — a youth dialogue closing with policy recommendations in October 2025.	REGRESSED
Kenya	A EUR 1.3m digital-rights project closed after 30 months, its 49-member coalition continuing unfunded. It reported 18,000 reached directly, 9.4m through campaigns and 133 defenders trained (close-out, grant). Civil society is the constituency that made the running on this ledger — the submissions on the artificial-intelligence policy, the warnings on metered billing, the petitions on automated decisioning and on borrower data — and the funded structure that carried much of it has closed. The same constituency is still publishing: a 2024 brief on fair and inclusive digital-tax reform (brief) was carried in September 2026 into a public campaign against the withholding tax on video-platform earnings (campaign) — unfunded advocacy continuing after the funded structure closed.	REGRESSED
Lesotho	A standing National Cybersecurity Forum was constituted in July 2026, spanning government, industry, regulators, banks and telecommunications providers. The forum held its inaugural meeting on 29 July 2026 and is standing rather than convened for an occasion (launch, account). It is the only structured route on file by which bodies outside government contribute to national digital policy, and no terms of reference, membership list or output from it has been published (report).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Liberia	The 2007 Act's consultation duty is binding and was exercised twice in the window. Sections 7(1) and 11(4) of the Telecommunications Act 2007 require the ministry and the regulator to consult publicly and take account of the results before adopting policy or exercising authority likely to have substantial sector impact – the clearest binding consultation duty the base holds. It was exercised on satellite communications guidelines from 23 February 2026, with a public forum, a comment deadline and a published consultation report. Outside the telecommunications duty, a two-day consultation in November 2025 brought civil society, academia, the private sector and the media into drafting the National Data Policy.	NO CHANGE
Libya	A Libya Experts Forum registration platform was reported ready for launch in July 2026, the one channel on file for outside expertise. The application was reported ready for launch on 23 July 2026, intended to register experts willing to contribute to national work (platform). No launch, registration count or terms of reference have been published since, and the base holds no other structured route for non-governmental contribution to policy.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	Multi-stakeholder consultation is running: a regional data-governance debate in May 2026 and an inaugural cybersecurity symposium in June. A national internet governance forum first convened in August 2020, run by a 17-member committee drawn from government, the private sector, the technical community and civil society, which held a public consultation and produced recommendations (report). The data-protection commission convened a regional public debate at Antsiranana in May 2026 with local authorities, universities, civil society and the private sector on data governance and biometric identity privacy (debate). An inaugural cybersecurity symposium in June 2026 brought private, technical and academic actors together with the ministry (symposium). No account of a consultation changing a published position is held.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	The action plan was formed through a multistakeholder process and industry was consulted on data-protection fees. The standing mechanism is the open government action plan for 2025 to 2028, whose participatory multistakeholder formulation the government describes in the plan itself. No implementation or self-assessment report against it is on file. 2026-07 - the regulator consulted stakeholders on draft data protection regulations and registration fees for significant controllers and processors, with private-sector input. 2026-07 - a multistakeholder validation workshop on the artificial intelligence readiness assessment was held on 22 July. Three consultations and no published record of what any of them changed: the base holds the invitations, not the responses.	MOVEMENT
Mali	A civil-society organisation launched a citizen application for reporting and checking online content in August 2026, closing a campaign it says reached 68,885 people. The application is aimed at young people and civil-society organisations, and was launched alongside the closing report of a digital campaign against viral falsehood that the organisation says reached 68,885 people (launch). The work is funded through a foreign-ministry facility with support from the ministry responsible for the digital economy, so it is civil-society delivery inside a state relationship rather than independent of it. No user or report-volume figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	A national internet governance forum convened in 2026 with the Vice President and the minister attending, and the clearest domestic objection to the AI-first framing was published in August. The forum is a national multi-stakeholder body founded by a civil-society movement; at its 2026 meeting a visiting alliance and an exchange met the Vice President and the minister to discuss artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and digital-trust frameworks for small island states. The record held is the visiting alliance's own release, and no programme, outcome document or attendance figure is held (forum). A named analyst argued in August 2026 that contract enforcement rather than technology is what limits the economy, prescribing digitalised case management alongside a small-claims process and a stronger commercial division rather than instead of them (argument). It is analysis rather than evidence, and it is the only domestic objection on file to the framing the budget adopts.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Morocco	A public argument for statutory platform responsibilities was made in the press in August 2026 by an association specialist and a researcher, against blanket blocking. A cybersecurity specialist from a digital-trust association and a social researcher argued that unrest had exposed gaps in the country's platform-regulation framework, warning against blanket platform blocking or breaking encryption and calling instead for statutory platform responsibilities, notice-and-response mechanisms and account-verification rules (argument). It is commentary rather than a state position, no such bill is held, and the base records no earlier instance of organised non-governmental input into digital policy against which to set it.	NO CHANGE a first record of the debate with nothing earlier behind it
Mozambique	Organised civil society submitted twice to the national dialogue: a 50-organisation youth coalition report in March 2026 and a nationwide consultation package in August. 2026-08-06 — a citizens' network submitted the proposals of a nationwide civil-society consultation to the national dialogue's technical commission, covering constitutional and electoral reform, natural-resource governance transparency and the digitalisation of public administration. 2026-03-13 — a coalition of more than fifty youth organisations submitted a consolidated consultation report to the same commission, following consultations that had run since 7 November 2025. Both are inputs, dated and documented. Neither the commission's response nor any adoption of a proposal is on file, so the channel is evidenced and its effect is not.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The 2022 consultation on the Data Protection Bill drew a coalition submission and an independent critique, and no further consultation is on record. The ministry opened public input in October 2022 with a closing date of 30 November; a civil-society coalition filed a submission on that date and a research institute published the same argument as a public paper in December, arguing the sections on the supervisory authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that the offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped (consultation, submission, critique). No ministry-published list of respondents is held and no further consultation activity is on record since. A separate three-year memorandum between the regulator and the chamber of commerce takes legislative reform as a joint workstream with a business lobby, which the instrument does not address (memorandum).	NO CHANGE
Niger	The policy consultation was described by the ministry as broad among digital-sector actors, and no open public-comment channel is named. A redrafting committee revised the draft policy from July 2025 (committee) and a national validation workshop in March 2026 was described as the product of broad consultation among public- and private-sector actors (workshop). Consultation is expert and stakeholder-level rather than a named open public-comment or civil-society submission channel, which is the whole of the record for outside contribution to policy here.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	A civil-society body built an artificial-intelligence tracker of online gender-based violence with more than 20,000 verified cases, and another monitors parties digital-rights compliance at elections. The tracker uses machine learning, localised keywords and context analysis to detect, categorise and monitor abuse in real time, flags actionable cases and produces evidence for referral; it is a civil-society body building the measurement layer the state has not (tracker). A separate platform tracks political parties' websites and social media for data-privacy violations and access restrictions during elections, piloted at a state governorship election with no findings published (monitor).	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	An internet governance forum convened its 2026 edition in July on digital trust and artificial-intelligence oversight, with no outcome document held. The edition convened on 30 July 2026 around digital trust and oversight of artificial intelligence (forum), with a parallel strand on young people shaping the country's digital future (young voices). No outcome document, government commitment or first-edition date is held, so the forum registers here as a convening rather than as an input the base can trace into an instrument.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sao Tome and Principe	A first internet governance forum was held over three days in July 2026, opened by the prime minister. The first edition was convened by the regulator and opened by the head of government (forum). No outcome document, participant count or commitment is published, and it is a first edition, so nothing yet establishes whether it becomes a standing channel. The one other route the base holds is also the regulator's: two public consultations on draft regulatory instruments (consultation). Both channels sit with the regulator rather than with a ministry or the legislature.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	A consultative digital council of twenty was installed in October 2025, and four draft reform laws were put to public comment. The Prime Minister installed the council on 2 October 2025 with 20 people drawn from the public sector, the private sector and civil society, to propose recommendations on national digital policy and accompany structuring projects. The record names no members, no meeting calendar and no weight for its recommendations. The Presidency placed four finalised draft laws — a constitutional revision, an organic law on the constitutional court, an electoral code creating an independent commission and a law on political parties — on a public digital platform and invited political actors and civil society to take them up, before tabling. The standing mechanism is the open government plan, whose second edition was made through regional citizen consultations with nearly four hundred participants, a national writing workshop and a validation workshop.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	Industry answered the virtual-asset licensing consultation with about fifteen written responses, and banks fed a cybersecurity baseline in 2025. The regulator's formal consultation response of March 2024 records about fifteen written responses and fifty to sixty live participants on the licensing framework (response); it is the fullest dated record of private-sector input to a digital or data policy process the base holds. In October 2025 the cybersecurity coordination committee and the bankers' association ran a joint workshop introducing a National Cybersecurity Baseline, with a member bank presenting a case study (workshop). In July 2026 the Vice-President agreed to involve the university in the consultation and planning stages of national digitalisation and AI initiatives (university).	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	A Technology, Innovation and Entrepreneurship Advisory Council held its inaugural meeting in February 2026, and the data protection Bill was consulted on nationwide. The advisory council was convened by the ministry and met for the first time on 5 February 2026, presented as a move from isolated pilots to a coordinated national approach (council). Nationwide consultations on the data protection Bill concluded in Bo in September 2025 (consultations), and a final national validation followed in November (validation). Parliament's own standing orders govern how business reaches the House (orders). No membership list, terms of reference or minutes are published for the advisory council.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	Civil society issued its own advocacy position in July 2026, three months after the regulator opened a draft framework to multi-stakeholder review. The regulator convened government, private sector, education, civil society and technical experts to review the draft cybersecurity risk management and compliance framework before finalisation (consultation) — a government-convened channel. The July position is different in kind: an advocacy forum of civil-society organisations, digital-rights advocates and legal practitioners issued a formal submission calling on the ministry, the regulator and the data protection authority to sign and ratify the African Union convention (position). The digital inclusion policy was separately finalised after a stakeholder validation workshop (policy).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The rights commission published a policy brief on information integrity and a provincial cluster convened a responsible-AI programme after the national policy was withdrawn. 2026-08-19 — the rights commission launched a policy brief on information integrity and human rights, grounded in the constitutional rights to expression, political participation and access to information, with a deputy minister stating that government should not become the custodian of truth on disinformation while the information environment should not be left to private platforms' algorithms. It is a brief rather than an instrument, and no legislative proposal or timetable follows from it on the record. 2026-08-17 — a provincial AI cluster announced a responsible-AI programme with the provincial economic development department, holding its first summit on 25 August 2026 on policy, governance, infrastructure investment and sovereign AI. It was convened after the national department withdrew the draft national AI policy, so what is on the record is non-state and subnational actors filling a gap rather than feeding into a process.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	The national internet governance forum convened in Juba in 2026, the standing route for non-governmental voices into ICT policy. The forum's secretariat describes it as the standing national multistakeholder platform, open to private sector, civil society and academia and stated to support national policy discussion (forum). The 2026 national forum convened in Juba with government, private sector, civil society, academia and development partners deliberating cybersecurity, digital rights and data protection, with outcomes stated to feed national policy (2026 forum). A civil-society organisation separately convened the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit to validate the Data Protection Bill in May 2026 (workshop). No record shows what any of it changed in a text.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	A private-sector forum called for a national strategy and a supreme council, and a private-sector engagement strategy was built on 71 interviews. The seventh edition of an operator-hosted forum on 31 May 2026 brought together university academics and external advisers who called for a national artificial-intelligence and digital-transformation strategy, a supreme council for digital transformation, and stronger public-private partnership (forum). A private sector engagement strategy published on 29 April 2026 rests on 71 key-informant interviews conducted in November 2025 with small firms, banks, associations, displaced firms and diaspora businesses (strategy). The older precedent is the statistics strategy, whose design process recorded consultation with private-sector actors, civil society and academia (strategy).	MOVEMENT
Togo	The national internet governance forum held its twelfth edition on 19 June 2026, with every digital regulator on the panels. The forum has run annually since 2010 under the international multistakeholder arrangement, convening government, civil society, private sector, academia and the technical community on internet policy — the standing mechanism, and the base holds no other. The twelfth edition, on 19 June 2026, took governing in the era of artificial intelligence, big data and geopolitics as its theme, with the digital ministry, the telecoms regulator, the digital agency, the cybersecurity agency, the identity agency and the data-protection authority named on the programme alongside civil society. The data-protection authority's own account of its panel sets out compliance duties on data controllers and announces forthcoming sectoral practical guides.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	A 2018 decree requires consultation on draft policy, laws and regulations, and nothing published shows what it has produced. The founding decree, gazetted in April 2018, requires consultation on public policies including draft legislation and regulation where a policy could directly affect stakeholders' vital interests, defines stakeholders to include civil-society organisations, experts and economic enterprises, routes consultation on draft laws and decrees through the national legal-information portal, sets notice and minimum-duration rules for both tracks, and requires a published consultation report before adoption alongside an annual evaluation. It is still cited by ministries as the basis for 2026 consultations. What the decree itself requires to be published — the per-consultation report and the annual evaluation — is not held for any year, so the mechanism's existence is on the record and its use is not.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	A joint civil-society submission was filed for the fourth-cycle periodic review, and a climate information integrity project launched in August 2026. The submission carries civil-society recommendations rather than government commitments; it carries no day on its cover and the date is padded to the month (submission, review). The climate project was launched in August 2026 with no budget or duration stated (project). Both are externally funded, which is why the foreign-funding cap in the sovereignty bill recorded separately bears on whether either continues.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	A constitutional consultation reported more than 11,864 public submissions, and a bill was deferred after civil-society concerns. A statute places non-state representation on national, provincial and district development coordinating committees and cluster advisory groups, and provides for state and non-state submission of budget policy proposals — participation as a standing statutory arrangement rather than an event. 2025-08 — the responsible minister deferred a bill on non-governmental organisations after civil-society and non-governmental stakeholders raised concerns, an explicit government response to non-state input. 2025-11-25 — a nationwide constitutional consultation reporting more than 11,864 public submissions through public sittings, submission boxes, website and email was handed to the President. It is the largest documented consultation on this ledger and its subject is the constitution rather than digital policy.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	The statistics strategy runs standing thematic working groups with non-state members, and civil society published an independent critique of the AI strategy in June 2026. The statistics strategy for 2021-2025 carries an annex of thematic working groups mapped to ministries, departments and agencies, and records that its own formulation involved civil society organisations and United Nations agencies alongside government (strategy). The artificial-intelligence strategy carries its own consultation record, closing at a provincial centre in September 2025 (consultations). At the strategy's launch the United Nations resident coordinator called for independent oversight capacities in government, civil society, academia and professional bodies, and for meaningful participation of affected communities (launch). A media rights organisation published its own analysis of the strategy's governance gaps in June 2026, the base's clearest instance of non-governmental scrutiny after the fact rather than participation before it (analysis).	MOVEMENT

Open discussion of government policy

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A platform-regulation bill is under examination and a national information-verification system is in draft; neither is adopted. 2025-10-30 - a private member's bill was deposited at the National Assembly and reported under examination: it would bind platforms above one million users in the country to a local office, a legal representative, in-country data storage, takedown within twenty-four hours and six-monthly compliance reports, and would create a regulator attached to the Presidency. The provisions are the outlet's reading, the bill text is not held, and nothing on file establishes adoption. 2026-07-23 - a national information-verification system was examined in draft by the Council of Government, with no regulator, legal basis or oversight mechanism named in anything held. Both would bear directly on what may be published and by whom, and neither has a text on file.	NO CHANGE two draft instruments extending state control over platforms and information verification are before the legislature and the Council of Government, neither adopted

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	A false-information law entered into force on 4 August 2026 carrying prison terms, and journalists' bodies warn it will inhibit citizen journalism. 2026-08-06 — the law was gazetted as Lei n. 6/26 and entered into force on 4 August 2026, after the National Assembly passed it 105 to 72 in May with only the main opposition against. It carries fines of 200 to 400 minimum wages, one to three years for simple publication, three to eight where it incites hatred or damages reputation, and up to ten in the aggravated case, and binds telecommunications operators, digital platforms and application providers, reaches content aimed at the domestic public from outside the country, and bans inauthentic accounts. 2026-08-22 — the journalists' union, the professional credential and ethics commission and the women journalists' forum warned that the law will inhibit citizen journalism, arguing that its penalties are excessive and that whether something counts as a journalistic error will depend heavily on how the courts and the aggrieved party read it. No enforcement action anywhere in the country is held, and civil society had raised the same objections as it came into force. The account of the text held is a law-firm note rather than the gazetted instrument.	REGRESSED
Benin	The country ranks fourth in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment, a reference ranking cited rather than absorbed. 2026-07-11 — a 2026 internet-freedom assessment places the country fourth in Africa. It is a reference ranking, cited and not absorbed, and no prior placing is held, so the base can state the position and not the direction. Nothing else on this ledger touches online expression: no content law, no platform regulation, no shutdown, no prosecution and no consultation on any of the digital instruments listed in this report appears. The one participation mechanism on record is the open government process reported above, which opened a month before the window closed.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	Botswana Speaks became a Parliamentary Services Division in April 2025 and released a mobile application on both app stores. 2025-04 — the citizen-to-Parliament platform transitioned into a Parliamentary Services Division, was upgraded, and a mobile application was released on both app stores; it is free and reachable by web and phone. 2026-04-13 — a public panel in Tlokweng on the proposed Constitutional Court drew legal experts, traditional leadership, political representatives and the public. 2025-10-13 — the health ministry opened the proposed national health insurance scheme to private providers and medical-aid societies at a stakeholder session. No usage figure for the platform is published.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	Broadcast-content regulation and data-protection supervision pass to one college under the August 2026 merger, the regulator holding powers over social-media users with 5,000 or more followers. The broadcasting regulator exercises powers over social-media users with at least 5,000 followers under an organic law whose operationalisation began in 2024. It is the only social-media-regulation instrument the base holds for the country, and nothing records any change to it. 2026-08-03 — its regulation of public communication passes to the merged authority, putting broadcast-content regulation and data-protection supervision under a single college. The merger removes the separation that let one body act as a check on the other, which is what makes this a regression rather than a reorganisation. The protection that might have offset it has not arrived: a whistleblower protection law was in preparation by the justice ministry in February 2025 and no held source records adoption or any further step in the eighteen months since.	REGRESSED
Burundi	Burundi hosted a regional internet governance forum for the first time in February 2026, against two decades of documented internet controls. A civil-society study mapping government internet controls from 1999 to 2019 records surveillance, restrictive media regulation, censorship of a named outlet and civil-society resistance. Its evidence base stops in 2019 and it is not a current snapshot. 2026-02-16 to 21 — Burundi hosted the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum for the first time, with eleven countries and government, youth, women, private-sector and technical participants, validating a 2026 regional roadmap. It is the clearest instance of open multi-stakeholder discussion of digital policy the base holds for the country. What it is not is evidence of domestic consultation on a domestic instrument: none of the strategies or laws in this chapter was published in draft for comment.	MIXED a first multi-stakeholder forum against two decades of documented controls

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	Four shutdowns were recorded in 2025, including election-period restrictions on social platforms, against none the year before. The base recorded no restriction in the year to August 2025. 2025-10-23 - restrictions were imposed during the presidential poll, part of four shutdowns recorded in Cameroon in 2025, including election-period restrictions on social platforms. One of the four was a cross-border cut that took the Central African Republic off a submarine cable. The legal basis is the 2010 cybercrime law, in force and invoked to justify network restrictions, with civil-society reform recommendations pending and none adopted. No order, duration or authorising instrument for any of the four has been published.	REGRESSED
Cape Verde	An Open Government Partnership Forum met for the seventh time in February 2026 to prepare a third national action plan. The Forum met in Praia on 26 February 2026 to reformulate its membership and prepare the third National Action Plan for Open Government, the second having been completed in 2025. The Minister for State Modernisation argued at it that citizens can only criticise, support or propose alternatives to government policy if they have access to the underlying information. eParticipa is separately in service as a web and mobile channel between the citizen and the public administration. The base holds no public-consultation register and no count of consultations run or responses received.	MOVEMENT
Central African Republic	The communications council asked for tighter subscriber identification and for platform account closures, acknowledging that its own competence covers media professionals. 2026-06-12 — at a press conference the communications council's president requested better control of subscriber identification to limit anonymous accounts, activation of international judicial cooperation against content produced abroad, and cooperation with international platforms on reporting and closing accounts. No instrument was adopted, and the council acknowledged that its own competence covers media professionals rather than the general public. Nothing else on this ledger touches online expression except the cybersecurity statute reported under legislation, which a commentator names as the instrument now used against online content. So the requests describe an intention to reach beyond an existing mandate, and the law that would already reach there is in force.	NO CHANGE requests to restrict anonymity made and no instrument adopted
Chad	A province was cut off from the internet for more than three months with no restoration on record, and the media regulator suspended examination of applications to create online newspapers until further notice. The province had been cut off since October 2024 and remained so at an internet society communique of February 2025; security reasons were cited but the base holds no official instrument, and restoration may have occurred unrecorded (shutdown). The regulator suspended examination of online newspaper applications with no end date; the communique carries no date of its own (suspension). The suspension is justified by a three-year strategic plan whose text is not held and which is known only through the communique that invokes it, one of its axes being to clean up the profession (plan). A report by two research organisations documents 44 fabricated identities — 35 ghost journalists and nine fake experts — placed in African media between 2021 and 2026 and linked to Russian influence operations (report). The report itself is not held, and no Chadian outlet or byline is named in the account that is.	REGRESSED
Comoros	The information and communication code was amended with the government's proposed exception to source protection struck on the floor. The 2021 statute stood unamended at 292 articles. The Assembly of the Union adopted an amending law by 31 votes of 33 deputies, amending twenty-five articles and deleting eighteen, with the government's proposed exception to source protection struck on the floor, so source protection is now unqualified. Neither the amending law's text nor a promulgating decree is held, and the whole account is one national-press report of the plenary. A legislature narrowing a government's own proposed exception is the clearest instance of open contest over digital policy the base records for this country.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	An international observatory recorded continued judicial harassment of a named human rights defender and the opening of his trial (report). An international observatory recorded continued judicial harassment of a named human rights defender and the opening of his trial. UNESCO published a national assessment of internet development in April 2026 using the ROAM-X indicators, whose findings set the adoption of legal frameworks and of the Vision Congo Digital 2025 strategy against insufficient enforcement of the cybersecurity and data-protection laws, high connectivity costs, persistent rural-urban disparities, barriers for people with disabilities and limited public participation in internet governance. That assessment is the only sustained published argument about data governance the base holds, and it is an external one: no Congolese civil-society, academic or parliamentary contribution to it is on the record.	REGRESSED
Cote d'Ivoire	An open-government week of public consultations ran in May 2026, while a study documents online gendered violence against election candidates. 2026-08-18 - a research organisation documented online gendered violence against election candidates as cyclical across successive elections in a two-country study covering Cote d'Ivoire and Tanzania. It is the only measurement of the phenomenon on file and it is the researcher's own. The base holds no regulator, electoral-commission or platform figure for the same thing, no state response to the study, and nothing earlier to compare it against, so the direction is withheld and the level is what is stated. 2026-05-18 - an open-government week ran to 22 May under the national theme of access to information for all, with in-person public consultations, awareness and information visits, civil-society and private-sector activities and a panel, opened by the sponsoring minister as focal point and followed by a ministerial declaration on 23 May. It is a participation mechanism in operation rather than a plan, and no record of what the consultations produced is held.	MOVEMENT
Djibouti	The President publicly set out the risks of the national digital identity system, and the Digital Code was discussed outside government. 2025-11-06 - the ministry presented the newly adopted Digital Code to a France-Djibouti business assembly, its legal adviser setting out the personal-data and electronic-commerce provisions. 2026-02-09 - closing the national digital identity forum, the President addressed identity theft, cloning, hacking, espionage and over-centralisation alongside the benefits, and called for continuing public vigilance. The setting bounds what this shows. A country panel dated April 2026 records the 1992 communication law as never substantially reformed and places the country 167th of 180 on the press-freedom index; the discussion on file is government-convened.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	The Council of Ministers adopted a government-wide strategy against abusive platform content on 28 August 2026, with a citizen alert mechanism and a review of regulation. The strategy was adopted at the Council's 97th session and carries an interministerial task force chaired by the communication ministry, a citizen alert mechanism, integration of media literacy into the school curriculum, and a technical and legal review of how the sector is regulated (strategy). The strategy text is not held; what is held is the Council's own account of what it adopted. Neither the account nor anything else on file defines abusive content, names who decides, or says what follows a citizen alert. It lands on a base that already records the digital code being enforced on the state's own initiative, with the attorney general instructing judicial police officers to open cases proprio motu (code). A reporting channel and a prosecutorial instruction are the two halves of the same mechanism.	REGRESSED
Egypt	The complaints system received 195,000 items in one month, while an assessment scores 5 of 40 on violations of user rights. 2025-10-08 - the unified government complaints system received 195,000 complaints, appeals, requests and enquiries in September 2025, of which 153,000 were routed to competent bodies. It is a grievance channel operating on that volume, and nothing states what came back. Against that, an international assessment scores the country 14 of 25 on obstacles to access, 9 of 35 on limits on content and 5 of 40 on violations of user rights, on a coverage period that ends before this window. The participation measure sits between them: an electronic participation index of 0.5890, ranked 74 of 193.	MIXED a large complaints channel against low scores on user rights

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Equatorial Guinea	A reform of the 1997 press law was presented in August 2026, regulating digital media and cable television for the first time. It was referred to a parliamentary committee alongside a separate copyright and related rights bill implementing the country's convention obligations; neither bill text is held and no adoption date is published (presentation, scope). A commission adopted 11 articles of the draft on 18 August 2026, leaving four outstanding, on the principles of the profession, the qualification required to practise, student interns, and professional secrecy; no plenary vote, text or commencement date is published (commission stage). 2026-09-04 - two enforcement bodies agreed to exchange information rather than to publish any: the attorney general's office and the anti-corruption commission agreed a permanent coordination mechanism of institutional liaison points, an information-exchange protocol and periodic reviews. No protocol text, data categories, safeguards or first review date is published, and neither body publishes a caseload.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	A press-freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 for the third consecutive year (index). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year, alongside China and North Korea, describing a state of press freedom that has hardly changed (index). A United Nations commission of inquiry found that the government systematically silences anyone who protests, questions or criticises it and its policy, and that surveillance and punishment produce self-censorship even in private and family settings (findings). There is no forum on the record — no independent press, no permitted civil society, no online space — in which digital or data policy could be publicly argued.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	The prime minister first dismissed a memorandum with a hyperscaler, then acknowledged in writing that Cabinet had approved it. A former minister defended the memorandum publicly and the attorney-general confirmed that Cabinet and legal consultation preceded signature (defence, account). The published analysis argues the memorandum was not the real problem. What the exchange establishes for this frame is narrower and sufficient: a head of government publicly denied and then confirmed the existence of an approved instrument, in writing, and that correction happened because the question was pressed in public.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	Public argument over telecommunications reform has moved from whether to liberalise to whether the state is provider or regulator. The monopoly ended in 2021 with one new full licensee since, and the published debate now turns on whether the state should act as provider or as regulator and partner (reform commentary). That is the only held instance of open policy argument, and it is a newspaper commentary rather than a consultation, a hearing record or a government response to either.	NO CHANGE
Gabon	A communications authority decision suspending social media has run about five months with no lifting date given. The decision was in force until further notice as at 17 July 2026, about five months after it was taken, and the decision text is not held (suspension). The Presidency describes it as temporary and conservatory (presidential framing), while nine civil-society organisations call it unconstitutional and beyond the authority's remit and demand its abrogation (advocacy report). February 2026 is inferred from a five-month count and independently from an operator's half-year filing, so the start is held to the month (operator filing).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gambia	Draft broadcasting and online content regulations went out for consultation in April 2026, one of seven instruments released together. The draft is made under section 226(1) of the Information and Communications Act in consultation with the regulator; its fourteen parts run from general obligations through a content complaints committee, licensing and professional standards, classification tiers, content monitoring, local content, public service broadcasting, watershed and children's programming, and enforcement (draft regulations). The information minister set out its child-protection provisions in August 2026, covering the identity of child victims, parental consent for interviews with children, and content that harms or exploits minors (provisions). Its execution block is unsigned and undated, and no consultation closing date or adoption date is published. The seven instruments include journalists registration guidelines, which is the part the press constituency is contesting.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	Citizens reporting demands for unofficial payments rose to 69 per cent in the second half of 2025 from 51 per cent, with digitalisation named as the response. The statistical service's governance series names digitalisation, fee transparency and public education as its remedies, citing a marked fall in bribery at the passport office after digitisation, a comparison asserted without a before-and-after figure (governance series). The Office of the Chief of Staff has directed the ten institutions the series flagged as high-risk to report back on remediation. It is a survey series rather than a case count, and the base holds no published response from any of the ten. 2026-09-01 — the civic education commission named misinformation, disinformation, hate speech and synthetic media a threat to democratic stability and social cohesion, its chair saying citizens can no longer treat seeing and hearing as proof; external support was announced at the same event for a verification and investigative skills programme (engagement). The commission states a threat; nothing on the ledger measures it.	REGRESSED
Guinea	Facebook, YouTube and TikTok have been restricted since 28 July 2026 with no authority acknowledging it and no official explanation held. The blocking was measured from 28 July and was still running on 7 August 2026, while the President was abroad (measurement, still running). A consumer union additionally reports one messaging service restricted and bandwidth broadly reduced for several months, with internet providers and mobile operators stating the decision was not theirs (union account), and businesses report disruption (disruption). A total two-hour national outage on 7 August 2026 was traced to the state landing-station operator, whose officials and the regulator both declined to explain it (outage).	REGRESSED
Guinea-Bissau	The transitional parliament passed a law on the dissemination of false information online, and the government first invoked it in July 2026. 2026-05-23 — the transitional parliament passed unanimously, with amendments, a Digital Integrity law on the dissemination of false information on the internet, presented by the government spokesman as aimed at those who spread hate and act against the State. The publication date, the entry-into-force date and the enforcement mechanism — including how it would reach citizens abroad — are not stated in the record. 2026-07-21 — the Ministry of Communication invoked the law for the first time the base records, in denying a claim that TikTok was to be shut down. It is the only instrument on this ledger addressing online speech, and nothing records a court, a regulator or a civil-society challenge testing it. No consultation on the bill appears either.	REGRESSED a new online-falsehoods offence with enforcement left unstated
Kenya	A joint framework for digital platform governance is in drafting that would replace safe-harbour immunity with earned protection. It was reviewed technically with an international body and the regulator in July 2026 and would add a joint regulatory oversight committee; no draft text, sponsor department or timetable is held (framework). The nineteenth Kenya Internet Governance Forum met under the Africa Tech Policy Summit with more than 300 participants and published its report on 27 August 2026, confirming Kenya as host of the global forum for the first time since 2011 (forum). 2026-09-04 - the programme's procurement went to court and lost. The High Court quashed the 2024 advisory opinion of the Attorney-General that had cleared payments connected to the Sh15bn Nightigale tender, referring the conflict-of-interest question to the anti-corruption commission, on a challenge by a consumer federation to two 2022-23 tender awards and the payment made to the communications regulator's former chairperson on the strength of that opinion. The judgment is not held and no response from the agencies is on file.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The one public contest on file is an allegation of political interference in regulator appointments, denied by the ministry and unanswered by the regulator. The outgoing chief licensing officer at the communications authority alleged at a media briefing reported on 22 August 2026 that the communications minister pressed the board to re-advertise the post rather than renew the five-year contract that expired on 31 May 2026, and that the universal service fund's executive secretary was removed in the same way (briefing). The minister stated the ministry has no role in recruiting the authority's managers, and the authority declined to comment. It is an allegation with a ministerial denial and no regulator response, and the base holds no inquiry into it.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The telecoms regulator's own revenue is unpublished, a corruption complaint against it is under investigation, and the police answered a procurement question with a denial. Its licensing fees, spectrum charges, regulatory levies and numbering receipts are not published, nor is an audited account of them (revenue secrecy, alarm). A complaint over the replacement traffic-monitoring arrangement was forwarded to the anti-corruption commission's investigation unit on 30 July 2026, with no evidence publicly produced and no findings made (complaint). The national police stated in August 2026 that no facility uses satellite internet and that connectivity comes from the state operator under an institutional contract, and confirmed buying used vehicles from an American firm; no contract, value or procurement record is published alongside the denial (statement).	REGRESSED
Libya	The constitutional declaration guarantees expression and sets no consultation duty; two consultations ran anyway in 2026. The consolidated declaration guarantees expression and privacy and imposes no obligation to consult before adopting policy, so every consultation in Libya is discretionary. Two ran in the window. The regulator reopened the draft national artificial intelligence charter for public comment five weeks before adoption in April 2026, and the information authority and the development programme opened community consultations for the seventh national human development report in February.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	The cabinet ordered pornographic sites blocked at provider level in July 2026, and a dedicated social-media law covering defamation and disinformation was announced. The Council of Ministers decided the blocking on 8 July 2026 on public-order grounds; it is in force as a cabinet decision with no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route specified (order). The communication minister announced a dedicated social-media law covering harassment, defamation and disinformation, with no draft held (announcement). The base holds no civil-society or parliamentary record on digital governance against which to set either, which is itself the state of the debate.	REGRESSED a cabinet blocking order in force with no appeal route and a speech law announced beside it
Malawi	Parliament and civil society held their first formal joint meeting on 18 March 2026, launching a structured platform. 2026-03 - Parliament and civil-society organisations met formally for the first time on 18 March 2026, launching a structured platform to replace previously fragmented engagement. A coalition separately put district-level budget-tracking evidence to parliamentary committees on the education budget. 2026-08 - a four-day regional consultation opened in Lilongwe on 19 August under ministerial patronage, gathering public sector, private sector, academic and civil-society input on artificial intelligence and digital inclusion. On digital regulation the parliamentary record is thinner than the platform suggests: one committee pledge to support review of mobile-money fraud legislation, and no debate, report or division on a data-governance instrument.	MOVEMENT
Mali	A newspaper editor was sentenced before the cybercrime pole, and a ministerial instruction directs prosecutors at social-media content. The editor was arrested in June by the national cybercrime unit and sentenced to twelve months with six suspended for undermining the credibility of the state; a press-freedom body describes authorities using cybercrime provisions to prosecute journalists (sentence, case). Neither the judgment nor the charging instrument is held, and the characterisation of a pattern is that body's. The justice ministry instructed prosecutors on 29 July 2026 to act on platform content, building on existing penal and cybercrime provisions with no new statute (instruction, account). A survey of 2,220 adults in April 2026 puts a short-video platform third among main news sources at 19.7 per cent, behind radio at 27.3 and television at 21.7 (survey, reporting).	REGRESSED cybercrime provisions used to prosecute a journalist while a ministerial instruction directs prosecutors at platform content

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	A ministerial communique restated penalties of up to Rs 1m and twenty years for online content, and identity verification for social media went to consultation. The communique restated that the 2021 Act penalises false profiles, cyber-harassment and the diffusion of undesirable content, that administrators of accounts, pages and groups must moderate flagged content when a competent authority reports it, and that penalties reach a fine of Rs 1m and up to twenty years' penal servitude (communique). It creates no new obligation and is enforcement signalling on a law five years old. A parallel communique defined undesirable content to include material that is deceptive or inaccurate (warning). Consultations opened in June 2026 toward a social-media identity verification mechanism, citing 2,300 online-harm cases in six months and frauds up to Rs 500,000 (consultation); the minister acknowledged the privacy and free-expression tension and the need to negotiate with platforms (consultation).	REGRESSED the state restating criminal exposure for online speech and consulting on identity verification for social media
Morocco	The ombudsman called publicly in August 2026 for administrative reform to be made one policy under a single lead, after finding agencies still demanding paper the law says they may not. The ombudsman's 2025 report found agencies still asking for paper copies of documents already held electronically and imposing undisclosed extra conditions, contrary to the simplification law; the finding reaches the record through a member's written question to the ministry, and no ministry answer is held (report). A vigilance memorandum of 24 August 2026 calls for simplification, digitisation and deconcentration to be coordinated as one workstream under a single, clearly located government lead, and proposes a national system for evaluating administrative performance on service quality, ease of access, delivery times, user satisfaction and how far administrations act on complaints (memorandum). The measurement architecture it proposes does not exist. The spyware allegations are argued rather than adjudicated. Two Moroccan commentaries on 8 September set out the domestic case: an academic rejected as overstated the July 2026 consortium findings tying Moroccan bodies to the compromise of the Spanish prime minister's phone, and a press analysis asked whether the Spanish courts will reopen a related file (commentary). Neither the findings nor any court filing is held.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The telecommunications traffic control regulations were declared unconstitutional in July 2026, and the government said days later it would pursue the same powers another way. The decree, approved in October 2025 and in force from December, gave powers to suspend or block services, compel call and internet-protocol detail records, issue binding technical norms and intervene in operator networks without consent (decree). Judgment 6/CC/2026 of 29 July 2026 voided those provisions (judgment). The ground was organic unconstitutionality, so the powers remain available to the assembly by statute. The government stated on 4 August 2026 that it respects the ruling and will seek the same end by another route, naming no bill, instrument or timetable (response, statement).	MIXED blocking and interception powers struck down by the constitutional court while the government states it will seek the same end by another route
Namibia	The ICT ministry took the cybercrime bill to three regions in February 2026 and launched its strategic plan regionally in January. The ministry consulted stakeholders from Kavango East, Kavango West and Zambezi on the proposed cybersecurity and cybercrime bill on 4 February 2026, having said in January that consultations would open on 2 February (consultations). The ministry's strategic plan for 2025 to 2030 was launched at Opuwo in January 2026 rather than in the capital (launch). The formal parliamentary route is the ministry's annual budget motivation, which sets out its digital agenda for the year (motivation). The base holds one published consultation record, from December 2022 on the data protection drafts. No submission count, consultation report or response document is held for any of the 2026 rounds. 2026-08-30 — the dominant operator publicly rejected customer claims that it takes data, attributing rapid depletion to streaming and hotspot sharing, and said it is building a control letting customers opt in or out of airtime being spent on data once a bundle runs out, with no implementation date given (discussion). It is the one item here where the public argument is with a company rather than a ministry, and it produced a stated product change where the ministry consultations produced no published response.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	Niger scored 27 of 100 in the 2026 freedom assessment, down from 30, against arrests of journalists and mass suspension of associations. The 2026 assessment scores Niger Not Free at 27 of 100, political rights at 3 of 40 and civil liberties at 24 of 60, with free media at 1 of 4 and the decline attributed to the dissolution of political parties, an appointed transitional advisory council and the dissolution of several trade unions. Six journalists were arrested in Niamey on 30 October 2025 for sharing an invitation to a state-organised press conference, three detained and charged under the cybercrime law with distributing a document liable to disturb public order. The interior ministry suspended hundreds of the 4,122 registered associations on 21 November 2025, including 332 foreign ones, for not publishing 2024 financial statements, leaving about 100 authorised to continue.	REGRESSED
Nigeria	A rights organisation and the editors' guild jointly called for enforcement of the Cybercrimes Act to be suspended pending repeal or revision, and no government response is on file. The state security service offered to pause its cybercrimes prosecution of a campaigner until after the 2027 election, and was told that pausing is not the remedy sought (report). The charges stand. They argue the 2024 amendment failed to cure the defect a regional court identified in 2022 when it ruled the original cyberstalking section vague, arbitrary and in breach of the African Charter, and that the amended text keeps ambiguous wording under which a prosecution can turn on someone claiming to feel fear (call). The call cites extrajudicial arrests, malicious prosecutions, enforced disappearances and unlawful surveillance reaching as far as posts in private messaging groups. No government or prosecutorial response is on file.	REGRESSED
Rwanda	The twentieth national dialogue resolved that performance contracts should better reflect citizens' concerns, and assembly guidelines were revised in June 2026. The sector strategic plan for 2024 to 2029 states in its own self-assessment that existing dialogue forums have not yet translated into effective influence over policy and budgeting (plan) — the government's own account of the gap. The twentieth national dialogue, convened 5 and 6 February 2026, resolved that performance contracts should better reflect citizens' concerns (resolutions). Revised guidelines in June increased citizens' assemblies from weekly to twice-weekly and routed reporting formally through the electronic complaints system (guidelines).	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	The regulator ran a second public consultation in September 2025, on the draft national cybersecurity strategy, having published its own responses to the first. The first consultation, on the draft electronic communications law, was launched in February 2024 and the regulator published a report setting out its legal basis and its point-by-point responses to the contributions received (report). The second put the 2024 to 2028 national cybersecurity strategy and its annexed action plan to public comment under the digital project, with contributions due within 30 days of publication and later submissions excluded (consultation). Both are the regulator's, on regulatory instruments. No consultation by a ministry, and no record of what either consultation changed, is held.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	Senegal enacted its first access-to-information law and adopted an integrated media regulator in the same window. The statute was promulgated on 4 September 2025 and gazetted on 25 September, its own explanatory memorandum stating that until it no law fixed how the right of access is exercised; it creates a national access commission, sets criminal sanctions and lists exclusions covering defence, investigation, judicial deliberation and government deliberation secrecy. The National Assembly then adopted on 3 March 2026 the bill creating a media regulation council, described as moving from a sectoral regulation limited to broadcasting to an integrated regulation of print, online press, content creators and foreign media, with a perimeter naming three international platforms and an emphasis on disinformation, hate speech and illicit content. The sanctions regime and appointment mechanism are not given. The measured series moved down: 78th of 180 with a score of 58.11, from 74th and 59.43, the sharpest fall in the security indicator. Infrastructure siting reached Parliament. A member put written questions to several ministers over the proliferation of telecommunications masts close to residential areas, seeking the conditions under which they are installed (questions). No siting rule, exposure standard or answer is held.	MIXED a first access-to-information statute enacted while a media regulator's perimeter was extended over online commentary and the press-freedom rank fell

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	Parliament amended the broadcasting Act in June 2026 to give appointment and dismissal power over the broadcaster board, and perceived media freedom fell on a survey round fielded in 2025. The base holds no primary text of the amendment; it is reported in a survey dispatch citing two press-freedom organisations (amendment). The perception measure is from a round fielded in 2025 and published in August 2026. It measures what people believe about media freedom rather than the media's legal position, and an international index placed the country 35th globally in 2026, up ten places (perception). Those two point in opposite directions and the cell carries both: a statutory change increasing executive control over the state broadcaster, and an external ranking improving.	REGRESSED
Sierra Leone	Criminal libel was repealed by the Public Order (Amendment) Act 2020; media regulation now runs through the Independent Media Commission. The 2020 Act repealed Part V of the Public Order Act 1965 - defamatory and seditious libel - and renumbered what remained (Act). The Independent Media Commission issued a ruling against an outlet in August 2026 (ruling), and the information commission presented its sixth annual report in November 2025 (report). The base holds the repeal and two institutional acts under it. It holds no measure of press freedom, no count of complaints, and no assessment of how the commission's rulings bear on reporting.	NO CHANGE
Somalia	A former prime minister published an opinion on resource governance, held because public argument of this kind is otherwise absent from this ledger. The piece is a signed opinion rather than a policy position (opinion). It is recorded because the alternative is to record nothing: no consultation response, civil-society submission or published critique of a digital instrument appears anywhere else in this unit, apart from the domestic analysis of interoperability risk. The information ministry says it closed 82,000 social media pages during 2026 that it alleges carried armed-group propaganda, across Facebook, TikTok and Telegram, with the count still rising (ministry). No legal basis, appeal route, oversight mechanism or platform confirmation is stated.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	The electoral commission is moving a disinformation code from draft to enforcement before the local elections, binding contestants against campaigning on falsehoods. 2026-08-24 — the electoral commission is moving its updated code of conduct on countering disinformation from draft to enforcement ahead of the local government elections. The existing code is extended to campaign mechanisms on new, digital and social media, and binds political contestants, candidates and their supporters against campaigning on falsehoods, with disinformation defined as false information circulated in the knowledge that it is false. The commission cannot itself find a breach or impose a sanction: where it investigates and forms the opinion that one may have occurred it must refer the matter to the Electoral Court. Alongside the code it is working with large platform companies on self-regulation, so that false content can be referred to them for takedown — which places a private takedown route beside a judicial one, with no published standard governing the first. The electoral commission gazetted its disinformation code for the local government elections on 9 September 2026, requiring parties and candidates to retract false information within 36 hours, label AI-generated content and report online disinformation to a designated platform (code); no gazette number or promulgation date for the final code is stated.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	The regulator ordered internet service providers to block social media for 30 to 90 days, a power exercised without a published legal basis. The information technology minister denied two documents alleging a US\$15m influence-buying transfer by the firms contracted for the e-government programme (report). The documents' authenticity is contested and the base holds no independent verification. The order was issued in January 2025 (order). No statutory basis, appeal route or duration determination is published for it. The cybercrime Act signed a year later criminalises false information, online impersonation and hate speech, so the same period saw both an administrative blocking power exercised and speech offences enacted, neither with a readable instrument behind it.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sudan	A six-year sentence over a private phone conversation was reported in August 2026, one of a series of cybercrime prosecutions for speech. A pharmacist was jailed for six years over a private phone conversation (sentence), inside a pattern of anti-war prosecutions under the cybercrime statute (prosecutions), and a journalist was detained under the same Act (detention). The two accounts date the statute differently, to 2007 and to 2008, and neither the judgment nor the charging instrument is held. So the law being used is one whose year the sources disagree on and whose text this base does not hold. The draft cybersecurity law now in redrafting does not state whether it touches these provisions.	REGRESSED
Tanzania	An influencer sued a platform company alleging government-directed account suspensions (suit). An activist and social-media influencer sued a platform company in the United States, alleging her accounts were disabled at the government's direction (suit). The allegation is untested and the base holds no government response. No gazetted instrument, directive or regulator order for the shutdown is held; the record is third-party monitoring only, and the monitor states its counts are subject to revision (shutdown, integrity, economy). Licensed online content outlets fell on the regulator's quarterly count to June 2026 (licences). A civil-society study measures online gendered violence against election candidates across cycles; the base holds no regulator, electoral-commission or platform figure for the same phenomenon, so it is the only measurement on file and it is the researcher's own (violence).	REGRESSED
Togo	Civic space is rated Repressed at 29 of 100, unchanged since 2020 after Obstructed in 2018 and 2019. The monitor's series shows Repressed for 2020 through 2024 after Obstructed in the two preceding years — a standing position, not a movement. The page carries no publication date and the rating is the one current at retrieval. One dated in-period statement bears directly on online speech: on 3 October 2025 the public prosecutor stated that anyone producing, circulating or sharing an unlawful publication would be prosecuted without compromise, and that even a comment endorsing unlawful content exposes the commenter — extending criminal exposure from authorship to endorsement, on the instruments of the penal code, the cybersecurity law, the data-protection law and the press code. It was published on the government's own portal, so it is the state's statement of its own position.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	Tunisia fell to 137th of 180 on the press freedom index, and a journalist was given a year's prison in July 2026. The general legislation committee named revision of the 2022 cyber-offences decree-law its top legislative priority in January 2026, with hearings planned for the journalists' union, the bar, magistrates and civil society, focused on article 24, though parliament's own case file shows the bill deposited in February 2024, referred to committee in April 2025, and still unvoted, with its operative text unpublished. In July 2026 the Sfax court of appeal handed a journalist a first firm one-year prison term, requalifying the case from that decree-law to article 86 of the telecommunications code. The country ranked 137th of 180 on the 2026 press freedom index, down from 129th, on a country entry naming the decree-law as the principal current threat.	MIXED parliament made revision of the speech law its priority while a journalist was jailed under another statute
Uganda	A regulator order suspended public internet around the January 2026 election, with social media still blocked a week after general restoration. A duration must name its endpoint: four days measures order to measured restoration of connectivity, almost five days measures order to the regulator's announced restoration at midnight on 18 January, and thirteen days measures order to full restoration including social media. The directive is held as a scanned document with no text layer, and no ruling in the Law Society suit is on file (order, restoration, record, directives). Social media and over-the-top services remained blocked after general internet was restored (block, signal). Revised judiciary media guidelines were issued through the case-management system for a High Court trial; the guidelines themselves are not on file (guidelines).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	Observer missions issued preliminary statements on digital systems in the 2026 general election, and a consent judgment requires a reason for any internet interruption within 36 hours. Two independent accounts of the August election period were published: one on the reach and risks of digital campaigning (account), and one recording that no internet shutdown was imposed and asking why (account). Four observer missions and a media body issued preliminary statements in August 2026; no final observer report, government response or electoral commission account of the accreditation and register decisions is held (statements, media, registration, assessment). The consent judgment was entered after election-period blocking in August 2021 and requires a reason for any interruption within 36 hours; it is known to the base only through a coalition letter (judgment). The Human Rights Commission considered 105 alleged violations and resolved 62; the listed remedies are administrative rather than adjudicative, and no sanction, compensation or determination is reported (cases).	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	A cyber security and monitoring of interception centre sits as a unit in the Office of the President, and a national truth-verification platform is proposed, layered on a false-data-message offence. The centre was established by the Cyber and Data Protection Act, which amends the interception statute to create it; the Act's long title and the reporting organisation's account name the body differently (centre, Act). The truth-verification platform is proposed in the artificial-intelligence strategy and is layered on the false-data-message offence and that monitoring centre (platform). A state truth-verification platform proposed on top of an existing false-information offence and an interception unit in the presidency is the combination, and the strategy that proposes it has no legal force.	REGRESSED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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